

Poetry Reading





About the Course

In addition to reading a variety of poems from 19th century authors, students read biographies of two famous 19th century poets and dive into Virgil's Aeneid.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grade 11, Literature: Grade 12, Literature: Grade 9, Literature: Grade 10



Placement & Combining Tips

Students new or struggling in their relationship with poetry should use Grade 8 lessons.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9-12	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 2 times/week 15 min	Poetry The Aeneid The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist Jump Back, Paul: The Life and Poems of Paul Laurence Dunbar The Crescent Moon

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 9				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 9		General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Poetry Study: Grade 9	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Plays: Grades 9-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 10				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 10 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12		General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	Poetry Study: Grade 10	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Plays: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 11				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Plays: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 12				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12		General Lit.: Grades 11-12	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 Plays: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view

online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

Poetry



The Aeneid



The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist



Jump Back, Paul: The Life and Poems of Paul Laurence Dunbar



The Crescent Moon



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

How To Approach



Read

The lesson plans will guide you through what to read over the terms. Take a moment before reading to remember where you left off last time.



Narrate

The lesson plans will give you specific instructions or tell you to choose a way to narrate that helps you interact with the ideas.



Discuss

The lesson plans will guide you with questions or instructions to share your ideas or what you are reading with others.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are occasionally added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. Literature lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where student can share their ideas.

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

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Term 1

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 1

Transition from Classicism to Romanticism

→ INTRO

Towards the end of the eighteenth century, writers were beginning to break from the rules of Classicism and experiment with poetic subject matter and form that, in retrospect, seem more aligned with the themes of Romanticism. Today, you will read a few works by three poets who bridge these two time periods: Thomas Gray, William Cowper, and Robert Burns.

→ READ & DISCUSS

∞ Link: *Elegy Written in a Country Churchyard*

- What is the setting of the poem, and how does Gray use this setting to create a mood or tone for the poem? What do you think the poet is saying about death and memory?

∞ Link: *The Shrubbery*

- How does the speaker show that there is a disconnect between how he feels and where he is? What is his relationship to the nature he sees around him?

∞ Link: *To a Mouse*

- If the language seems hard, try reading it out loud!
- This poem ends with a turn - why does the speaker see the mouse as "blest, compar'd wi' me!"?

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 2

William Wordsworth

→ INTRO

We will learn more about William Wordsworth (1770-1850) in the History of Literature lesson next week, but today's reading should give you a feel for his style and major themes. As you read, compare Wordsworth's poem to the selections you read last time. "Tintern Abbey" is written in blank verse (unrhymed iambic pentameter, or ten syllables per line). What other poets have you read that use blank verse? How is this different than Gray's "Elegy" you read last week, that had a very rigid structure?

∞ Link: *Lines Composed a Few Miles above Tintern Abbey, On Revisiting the Banks of the Wye during a Tour. July 13, 1798*

- What are some images that especially stand out to you? What is Wordsworth saying about nature?
- What do you think he means when he says in lines 64-67: "here I stand, not only with the sense / Of present pleasure, but with pleasing thoughts / That in this moment there is life and food / For future years."?

→ VIEW

Look at this painting of Tintern Abbey painted in 1804 by English landscape painter William Havell (1782-1857).

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 3

William Wordsworth and Samuel Taylor Coleridge

→ INTRO

With the anonymous publication in 1798 of their *Lyrical Ballads*, Wordsworth and Coleridge introduced a new style of poetry to the public. The initial publication received mixed reviews, however, and with each subsequent publication, the two poets included a Preface by way of an introduction to their style, themes, and purpose. In today's lesson, you will read excerpts from the 1802 edition of this preface, as well as a representative poem by each of them. Think about how the poetry you

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

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Term 1

read illustrates some of the points made in the Preface.

→ READ & DISCUSS

1. ∞ PDF Link: Excerpts from the Preface to the Lyrical Ballads (1802)

2. Wordsworth, "My Heart Leaps Up"

My heart leaps up when I behold

A rainbow in the sky:

So was it when my life began;

So is it now I am a man;

So be it when I shall grow old,

Or let me die!

The Child is father of the Man;

And I could wish my days to be

Bound each to each by natural piety.

3. ∞ Link: Wordsworth, "I Wandered Lonely As A Cloud"

4. ∞ Link: Coleridge, "The Rime of the Ancient Mariner"

• NOTE: This poem is too long to read completely today, but reading it for a few minutes will give you a feel for the style. If you enjoy it, please finish reading it during the next poetry class or during your free reading time!

WEEK 2 □ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 4

Samuel Taylor Coleridge

→ INTRO

Today we are going to read a poem much different in style from The Rime of the Ancient Mariner. As you read, think about other poems you have read about children, or by poets remembering their own childhood.

∞ Link: Frost at Midnight

With any time remaining, you can read more of The Rime of the Ancient Mariner.

★ TEACHER TIP

There is a Poem Guide for Frost at Midnight at the Poetry Foundation link, if your student would like extra information about the poem or help with understanding it.

WEEK 3 □ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 5

Rabindranath Tagore

□ Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ INTRO

We will spend much of Term 1 reading poems by the Bengali writer, philosopher and artist Rabindranath Tagore, who was born in 1861 in Calcutta, India, and grew up in a family that loved art, music, and ideas. He wrote in Bengali, but translated his own works into English. He is a significant figure for Indian nationalism, and, though not himself a politician, was a vocal proponent of India's independence at the turn of the twentieth century. In 1913, he became the first non-European writer to be awarded the Nobel Prize for Literature. He also composed the national anthems for both India and Bangladesh, making his words a lasting part of two nations.

The Crescent Moon is a collection of forty poems exploring themes such as childhood wonder, the natural world, imagination. As you read through these poems, think about other poems you have read that present the world through the eyes of children, such as Robert Louis Stevenson's A Child's Garden of Verses.

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.6-7 "The Home"

• How would you describe the speaker of this poem?

★ TEACHER NOTE

If you are note taking the History of Lit 9-12 course, you may wish to watch this introduction to the life and work of Rabindranath Tagore during some free time.

∞ Video Link: Rabindranath Tagore – Mystic Poet, Literary Genius & Nobel Laureate

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

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Term 1

- The poem opens with two examples of personification (a figure of speech which gives human characteristics to non-human things). Why do you think Tagore uses these images of a miser and a widow?

p.8 "On the Seashore"

- What images stand out most to you in this poem? How might they be symbols of a deeper meaning that lies beneath a simple description of children playing?

p.9-10 "The Source" and "Baby's Way"

- What do these two poems together seem to say about the nature of infants and children?

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 6

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.11-16

p.12-13 "Sleep-Stealer"

- Do you think someone really stole the baby's sleep?
- What phrase is repeated throughout the poem? Why do you think this is?
- How does the poem blur the line between the real world and the imaginative world?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 7

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.17-22

p. 19 "Playthings"

- How does the poem compare child's play to adult work, and which seems more satisfying?
- What "art" has the adult forgotten?
- What does the poem mean when it says adults spend their lives seeking "costly playthings"? Does this create success and happiness?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 8

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.23-29

p. 23-24 "Fairyland"

- Why do you think the child whispers the secret to the mother instead of telling everyone?
- In what ways can imagination transform ordinary places into something wonderful and special?

p. 28-29 "Paper Boats"

- What is inside the boat during the poem?
- What do you think the child imagines will happen to the paper boats on their journey?
- Why do you think the child hopes that "someone in some strange land" will find the boats?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

→ VIEW

∞ Picture Link: Tulsi plant

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 9

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

📄 Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.30-35

p. 33-34 "The Merchant"

- What gifts would you bring home if you traveled to magical lands like the child in the poem?
- What do the different gifts chosen for the mother, father, and brother reveal about how the child sees each person?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

→ VIEW

∞ Picture Link: Shiuli flower (The English name is night-blooming jasmine.)

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 10

Percy Bysshe Shelley

→ INTRO

Today, we are turning our attention to the first of two second-generation Romantic poets: Percy Bysshe Shelley. While he was inspired by the work and thought of Wordsworth and Coleridge, he has a style all his own. Look for some of the themes you've been learning about from the Romantic Period.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The first two poems are sonnets: what do you already know about sonnets? How does the form support the meaning of the poem? Both these poems have guides, if you would like to read about them further.

∞ Link: Ozymandias

∞ Link: England in 1819

- What do you know about what was happening in English around the year 1819?

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

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Term 1

2. In these second two poems, consider how Shelley is representing nature.

∞ Link: Ode to the West Wind

∞ Link: Mont Blanc

• What poetic images stand out to you the most?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 11

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Shelley that you read in the last lesson?
What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.36-40

p. 36 "Vocation"

- Why does the child think the hawker, gardener, and watchman have exciting lives?
- How does the poem contrast school life with the child's longing for independence?
- What does the poem suggest about our tendency to imagine that other lives are freer or happier than our own?

p. 40 "Authorship"

- Did you catch the line about the child making a paper boat? Do you think this is the same child who made paper boats in a previous poem?
- What kinds of stories does the child wish the father would write?
- How does the poem show the difference between the way children and adults value work, play, and creativity?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 12

John Keats

→ INTRO

Today, we will meet the second of the second-generation Romantic poets: John Keats. As we did with Shelley, look for some of the themes you've been learning about from the Romantic Period. There is only one poem to read today, because your understanding and appreciation of it will increase with multiple readings. Read it through more than once on your own, and if you would like some interpretive help, there is a link to a Guide to the poem.

∞ Link: Poem Guide: Ode on a Grecian Urn

This poem, Ode on a Grecian Urn, is a famous example of ekphrasis, or the poetic descriptions of a work of art. As you read, think about how the poetry engages with other arts, such as sculpture and music. What does it have to say about the limits of any one art form, or, put more bluntly, what can poetry do that sculpture can't, and vice versa?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Ode on a Grecian Urn

- The final enigmatic two lines have been an interpretive puzzle since Keats wrote this poem - what do you think he means by "Beauty is truth, truth beauty,—that is all / Ye know on earth, and all ye need to know." And why are they in quotation marks?

→ VIEW

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

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Term 1

It is helpful to have an image of what Keats is describing when reading the poem.

∞ Link: Sketch of an Urn by Keats

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 13

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

📄 Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.41-46

p. 49 "The Banyan Tree". The Banyan tree is the national tree of India.

- Why do you think the child wants to be the wind, a bird, or a duck?
- How does the poem show movement through the images?
- What might the child learn from quietly watching nature every day?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Parable of the Banyan Tree

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 14

John Keats, cont.

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. ∞ Link: Ode to a Nightingale

- What does the nightingale represent to Keats in this poem?

2. The other two poems by Keats are both sonnets written in response to other works of art. The first he wrote after reading George Chapman's translation of Homer, and the second in response to the Elgin Marbles (statuaries from the Parthenon) when they first were displayed at the British Museum.

∞ Link: On First Looking into Chapman's Homer

∞ Link: On Seeing the Elgin Marbles

→ VIEW

A slide show of the sculptures that Keats would have seen.

∞ Link: The Elgin Marbles at the British Library

• EXTRA HELPING

The Elgin Marbles are controversial, and Greece has requested their repatriation. Read more about the controversy here.

∞ Link: The Elgin Marbles

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 15

Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda

📄 Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ INTRO

Today we will begin a novel in verse about the Cuban-Spanish Romantic poet Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda (1814-1873) who used her writing to speak out against injustice of all kinds. If you have not read her biography already, it is linked below.

∞ Article Link: Biography of Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

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Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

p.169-174 "Historical Note"

p.ix "Historical Background"

p.3-10 "Books are door-shaped" - "like oxen or mules."

- Who are the people? Make a character list. Each week as you read, think about the different perspectives of the poems and how each one sees the same situation very differently. Share your observations in your narrations.
- How do the alternating viewpoints allow the poems to speak to each other. Look for poems that discuss the same topic but from different perspectives.

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 16

Lightning Dreamer, cont.

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What were your first impressions of these poems?

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

p.11-24 "I feel like a new person" - "dark or light."

- How are the nuns able to support Tula?
- How did Tula's father influence her, and how has he death shaped who she is at thirteen?
- Continue to add to your character list.
- How do the alternating viewpoints allow the poems to speak to each other. Look for poems that discuss the same topic but from different perspectives.

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 17

Lightning Dreamer, cont.

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What do you recall from

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

p.11-24 "I feel like a new person" - "dark or light."

- How are the nuns able to support Tula?
- How did Tula's father influence her, and how has he death shaped who she is at thirteen?
- Continue to add to your character list.
- How do the alternating viewpoints allow the poems to speak to each other. Look for poems that discuss the same topic but from different perspectives.

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 18

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.47-50

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

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Term 1

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 19

Lightning Dreamer

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 20

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.51-54

p. 54 "The Last Bargain"

- Why do you think the child chooses the child instead of the king, the old man, or the fair maiden?
- What do you think the speaker discovers about freedom by the end of the poem?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

→ LISTEN

Tagore's words became the basis for both India's and Bangladesh's national anthems. You can listen to them here with an English translation.

∞ Music Link: Jana Gana Mana - India National Anthem English lyrics

∞ Music Link: "Amar Shonar Bangla" - Bangladesh National Anthem Bangla & English lyrics

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 21

Catch-up

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 22

Tagore - Fireflies

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 23

Exam

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 24

Exam

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

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Term 2

WEEK 1	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 25	• IMPORTANT DATES Virgil (70BC - 19BC)
WEEK 1	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 26	
WEEK 2	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 27	
WEEK 2	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 28	
WEEK 3	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 29	
WEEK 3	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 30	
WEEK 4	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 31	
WEEK 4	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 32	
WEEK 5	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 33	
WEEK 5	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 34	
WEEK 6	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 35	
WEEK 6	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 36	
WEEK 7	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 37 <i>The Aeneid - Introduction</i> Materials: The Aeneid → INTRO What do you know about an "epic" – what are the connotations of the word more broadly, and what do you know about epics in literature? Name any you have read and what you remember about epic conventions. Virgil's Aeneid is an epic that owes much to Homer's two books, The Iliad and the Odyssey, which you may have already read in part or as a retelling. Chronologically, the story of The Aeneid picks up where the Iliad left off - with the fall of Troy - but Virgil lived 700-800 years after Homer, in a very different world. During Virgil's lifetime, the Roman Republic was coming to an - at times violent - end, and amid this uncertainty, Virgil looked backwards and chose the founding of Rome as his epic subject: following the Trojan Aeneas from the destruction of Troy to the founding of a new city. C.S. Lewis, in his Preface to Paradise Lost, saw epics like the Iliad, the Odyssey, and Beowulf, as "Primary Epics": they are works written down after a long tradition of oral storytelling, and tell the story of heroic deeds in order that such deeds may be remembered. They are myth-making stories, far more concerned with the life of one hero - Achilles, Odysseus, Beowulf - than with the wider historical context. However, Lewis argues that something new happens with Virgil, and the Aeneid is the earliest example of a "Secondary Epic": "one of the most important revolutions in the history of poetry." In The Aeneid, Lewis writes, Virgil "decides to take one single national legend and treat it in such a way that we feel the vaster theme to be somehow implicit in it. He has to tell a comparatively short story and give us the illusion of having lived through a great space of time. He has to deal with a limited number of personages and make us feel as if national, or almost cosmic, issues are involved. He must locate his action in a legendary past and yet make us feel the present, and the intervening centuries, already foreshadowed."	• COMPOSITION - Compare/Contrast Compare The Aeneid's opening Invocation to the Muse (lines 1-13) to the openings of The Iliad and The Odyssey. ∞ PDF Link: Iliad Opening Lines ∞ PDF Link: Odyssey Opening Lines • How is Virgil both imitating Homer and also doing something very new?

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

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Term 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. This helpful introduction to the Aeneid should give you a clear overview of the context of the epic and the general plot before we dive into the poem itself. You can read some of it today (skip the three exercises), or refer to it as you are reading the poem if you feel stuck.

∞ Link: Introduction to Virgil's Aeneid

2. Book 1, lines 1-96 "Wars and a man I sing" - "King of Cloudbursts."

- Today is a short reading to allow you time to look up characters in the Pronouncing Glossary (p.424-484) and begin to make a character list, if you would find that helpful.

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 38

The Aeneid, cont.

📖 Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading? How does Virgil open his epic?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 1, lines 97-367 "With such thanks" - "the men of Troy."

- What have you learned so far about the Aeneas's character? Why do you think he "assumes a look of hope / and keeps his anguish buried in his heart?"

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 39

The Aeneid, cont.

📖 Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 1, lines 367-595 "But Aeneas, duty-bound" - "who dares to battle men."

- What have you learned so far about the gods? How do they interact with mortals?
- Why do you think Venus comes to Aeneas in disguise?
- Why does Aeneas have such an emotional reaction when he sees images of the Trojan War displayed in Carthage?

→ CLOSE READING

- 517-528: This is an example of an epic simile, which is an extended comparison. Here Virgil compares workmen making a theater to the labor of bees. Why is this a striking comparison?

- **COMPOSITION** - Descriptive
Try writing your own epic simile.
It can be in prose or verse.

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 40

The Aeneid, cont.

📖 Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 1, lines 596-908 "And now / As Trojan Aeneas" - "and seas on earth."

- Why does Venus send Cupid disguised as Ascanius? Do you think Venus is trying to protect Aeneas, manipulate the situation, or both?
- Is Dido responsible for her eventual feelings for Aeneas if the gods interfere so heavily? What early signs in this passage hint that the

- ★ **TEACHER NOTE**
Aeneas's son is called both Ascanius and Iulus.

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

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Term 2

relationship between Dido and Aeneas may become tragic?

- How much free will do mortals seem to have in the epic? This is a question to come back to as you read further.

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 41

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 2, lines 1-255 "Silence. All fell hushed" - "nor all the thousand ships."

- Have you heard the phrase "beware the Greeks bearing gifts" before? Why do you think it has become an adage?
- Why do you think Virgil chooses to recount the fall of Troy through the narrative of Aeneas rather than directly? How do you see Aeneas's emotion shaping the story he tells?
- What role does Sinon play in this section?

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 42

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 43

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 2, lines 256-501 "But a new portent" - "they know so well."

- Can you find epic similes in this section? Why do you think there are so many of them in battle scenes?
- What is the significance of Aeneas dreaming of Hector's ghost? What message does Hector have for Aeneas?
- Why does Aeneas keep fighting even once it is clear that Troy is lost?

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 44

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 45

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 2, lines 501-725 "But oh / how wrong to rely" - "bow to my commands."

- Why is Priam's death such a turning point in the fall of Troy? What details does Virgil include to make it particularly tragic?
- What is Aeneas's reaction to Priam's death?
- Why does Venus appear at that moment, and what is her message to Aeneas?

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 46

Tennyson

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

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Term 2

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 47 <i>Exam</i>	
WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 48 <i>Exam</i>	

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

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Term 3

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 49

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 2, lines 725-998 "There / yes, where you see" - "headed toward the mountains."

- Venus shows Aeneas the actions of the gods in the fall of Troy - what does this say about fate and human action?
- Is Aeneas at fault for what happens to Creusa? Why or why not? How is your answer affected by her ghost's final speech?
- Book II ends with Aeneas carrying his father and leading his son. How is this symbolic for the past of Troy and the future of Rome?

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 50

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ INTRO

Book 3 begins with Aeneas and his companions escaping from the destruction of Troy and beginning their arduous journey westward to Italy. They encounter several challenges and false starts along the way. Eventually, Aeneas hears that the Trojan Helenus, who has married Hector's widow Andromache, has settled in Buthrotum, and that is where our reading for today resumes.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 3, lines 350-592 "Here an incredible story" - "challenge all our children."

- Helenus, son of Priam and a seer, and Andromache are both characters from the Iliad. Why is it significant that Aeneas meets them at this point, and what prophecy does Helenus offer Aeneas?
- How is Buthrotum described? Is it familiar to Aeneas? Why does he choose to move on rather than stay and settle in a "miniature Troy"?
- In this section, does Aeneas seem more like a warrior, a leader, or a pilgrim guided by fate?

→ VIEW

The following map is a helpful guide as you read about Aeneas's journey:
∞ Map Link: Map of the Voyage of Aeneas and the Mythic Origins of Rome

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 51

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ INTRO

Paul Lawrence Dunbar was one of the first Black Americans to earn a living as a writer and he inspired many other literary giants that would come after him. In fact, "I know why the caged bird sings" (one of the most iconic lines in African American literature and the title of Maya Angelo's autobiography) comes from one of Dunbar's poems. He was the only Black student in his high school, and became friends with Orville Wright and his brother Wilbur (who you may remember as the inventors of the airplane).

• EXTRA HELPING

For more on Paul Laurence Dunbar, you can read his full biography here:

∞ Link: Paul Laurence Dunbar bio

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

The Wright brothers owned a printing press and published Dunbar's first writings. While Dunbar only lived to age 33, he has been described as "your favorite poet's favorite poet" due to the impact his large body of work had on future writers. Older students may want to read more about Dunbar in extra helpings.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.103-104 "Author's Note"

p. 1-10 "You never heard of" - "could try again."

- Why do you think the book says "it's almost like two different men wrote those two poems"? What are some of the differences both in form and content?

- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once.

Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Fifth Massachusetts Colored Calvary

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 52

The Aeneid, cont.

📖 Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ INTRO

Book 3 begins with Aeneas and his companions escaping from the destruction of Troy and beginning their arduous journey westward to Italy. They encounter several challenges and false starts along the way. Eventually, Aeneas hears that the Trojan Helenus, who has married Hector's widow Andromache, has settled in Buthrotum, and that is where our reading for today resumes.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 3, lines 350-592 "Here an incredible story" - "challenge all our children."

- Helenus, son of Priam and a seer, and Andromache are both characters from the Iliad. Why is it significant that Aeneas meets them at this point, and what prophecy does Helenus offer Aeneas?

- How is Buthrotum described? Is it familiar to Aeneas? Why does he choose to move on rather than stay and settle in a "miniature Troy"?

- In this section, does Aeneas seem more like a warrior, a leader, or a pilgrim guided by fate?

→ VIEW

The following map is a helpful guide as you read about Aeneas's journey:

∞ Map Link: Map of the Voyage of Aeneas and the Mythic Origins of Rome

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 53

Jump Back, Paul

📖 Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Paul Dunbar's family from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.11-16 "Little brown baby" - "Come in hyeah, you scamp!"

p.108-110 "Joshua Dunbar" - "for their beauty, as well."

p.17-20 "Matilda Dunbar loved" - "an' say good night."

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

- Paul Dunbar is acclaimed by literary historians for his innovation and experimentation. Where do you see evidence of that in the poems you are reading?
- Look closely at "When de Co'n Pone's Hot" (p.13-14): can you identify the meter (syllables per line) and a regular rhyme scheme? Is there a pattern? For an even bigger challenge, see if you can identify which syllables in each line are stressed (have more emphasis when you pronounce them). Is this regular, too?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 54

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ INTRO

After Aeneas leaves Buthrotum, he and his men sail near the land of the Cyclopes and rescue Achaemenides, a Greek who was left behind after Odysseus escaped the Cyclopes Polyphemus in The Odyssey. They then reach Sicily, where Aeneas's father dies, presumably of old age (3.818-829). We will pick up the story again with Book 4.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 4, lines 1-247 "But the Queen" - "piling fuel on his fire."

- How much of what happens in this section is individual choice, and how much is fate controlled by the gods?
- What do you think of Anna's advice?
- Where do you see foreshadowing of tragedy in the way the love story is described?

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 55

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Paul Dunbar's family from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.20-28 "Now, school" - "had made it possible."

p.110-111 "Central High School" - "Ohio Historical Society, Columbus."

p.29-31 "When Paul commenced" - "Who fought for Uncle Sam."

- Why do you think Dunbar chose not to write in dialect when composing "The Colored Soldiers"?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence. Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 56

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the opening of Book 4?

★ TEACHER TIP

Sensitive content: preview the opening of today's reading, Book 4, line 248.

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 4, lines 248-494 "Iarbas - son of an African nymph" - "down upon her bed."

- How does Virgil describe Rumor? What makes Rumor such a powerful force in society and politics?
- What causes Aeneas to decide to leave Carthage?
- Do Dido and Aeneas seem to understand their relationship in the same way when they have their final conversation?
- If you have read the Odyssey, do you see a parallel in Odysseus's journey with Aeneas's time in Carthage?

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 57

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Paul's time in school from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.32-40 "Door after door closed" - "likely just the way it was."

p.111-112 "The Western Association of Writers" - "ghosts and goblins."

- What images in "Sympathy" stood out to you the most? Does it remind you of anything else you've read this year?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence. Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

• EXTRA HELPING

Listen to the poet and author Maya Angelou recite Sympathy.

∞ Video Link: Maya Angelou recites Sympathy

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 58

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 4, lines 494-653 "But Aeneas / is driven by duty" - "Dido says her prayers."

- How many of Aeneas's choices are his own, and how many are dictated by fate and the gods?
- Why does Dido decide that death is her only option?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 59

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.41-48 "I don't suppose" - "but who could he share them with?"

- Does the language and style of "The Unsung Hero" remind you of anything else you've read? What images stand out to you the most?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once.

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

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Term 3

Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.
Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 60

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 4, lines 653-876 "The dead of night" - "dissolved in the winds."

- How are Dido's and Aeneas's actions contrasted with each other's in this section?
- What details does Virgil include that heighten the tragedy of Dido's death?
- Why does Juno send Iris to Dido?

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 61

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.48-56 "But I don't want you to think" - "how deep you dig."

p.112-113 "It would be a shame" - "border of the United States."

p.57-60 "Chicago was behind Paul" - "nuffin' in de pot."

- Why do you think this poem is called a sermon? What is the message of the sermon?
- What does the author mean when she says "Studying a poem isn't like solving a problem in math"?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once.
Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.
Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 62

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ INTRO

In Book 5, Aeneas and the other Trojans leave Carthage and return again to Sicily. There they decide to hold funeral games - including races, boxing, and archery - to honour Aeneas's father Anchises. While the games are going on, the Trojan Women decide to try and burn the ships so that their journey will end there, but Jupiter sends rain to put out the flames. Aeneas is encouraged by the ghost of his father to continue his journey, but those who no longer want to join him are given the option to stay with King Acestes in Sicily.

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 6, lines 1-248 "So as he speaks in tears" - "into the vatic Sibyl's shrine."

- How is the Sibyl of Cumae both a prophet and a warning figure? What does she reveal to him about his future?
- Why does Aeneas want to go to the Underworld? What does the Sibyl tell him?

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 63

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.60-66 "It was time for another book" - "in a broken tongue."

p.114 "In the 1800s" - "member of the family."

p.67-69 "I suppose by now" - "you are welcome, welcome."

- The author writes "Seems to me that when he started putting together his second book, Paul must have been listening to his heart and his head both." Which qualities of his poetry do you think come from his heart, and which ones from his head?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence. Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

• COMPOSITION

How did the hardships of Dunbar's childhood shape him as a writer and a person? Why do you think those same difficulties became a source of strength rather than holding him back?

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 64

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ INTRO

Our reading picks up today once Aeneas has entered the Underworld and seen a number of people whom he knew.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Book 6, lines 521-554 "And wandering among them" - "pities her as she passes."

- Why do you think Dido does not speak to Aeneas? Who does he blame for her death?

2. Book 6, lines 786-1039 "Now father Anchises" - "the sterns line the shore."

- What does Aeneas's father Anchises show to him? Why is this a significant turning point halfway through the epic?

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 65

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.69-78 "Majors and Minors" - "a brave man to voice it."

p.114-115 "When Alice's answering letter" - "by Jerome Dowd."

- Why do you think Dunbar chose the tree to recount the story of the murder?
 - What are some of the other poems you have read so far by Paul Dunbar that seem to be addressing the racism and inequality described in today's reading?
 - Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.
- Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 66

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ INTRO

We are skipping Book 7 because of time constraints, but in the remaining readings from the Aeneid, you will notice a change of subject matter and style. If the first six books mirror the events of the Odyssey, the final six books mirror the events of the Iliad, with its martial theme.

In Book 7, Aeneas and the Trojans finally arrived in the Italian lands they have been promised by fate. They meet King Latinus, who believes fate has chosen Aeneas to marry his daughter Lavinia, but Juno's fury sets in motion a chain of events that destroys this early peace and sets the stage for war.

Our reading today picks up partway through Book 8, after Aeneas has made an alliance with King Evander, whose son Pallas leads an army to give Aeneas assistance.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Book 8, lines 717-858 "But the goddess Venus" - "all his children's children."

- What images does Vulcan forge onto the surface of the shield? Why are they significant at this point in the epic? Does this section help you understand what Lewis means when he argues that Virgil "must locate his action in a legendary past and yet make us feel the present, and the intervening centuries, already foreshadowed"?
- This section is another example of ekphrasis: a poetic description of a work of art. How does Virgil draw attention to the sculptural features of the shield? Could this shield actual exist as described, or is it mythical?

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 67

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.79-90 "There, now, I guess" - "telling those stories too."

p.116 "Will Marion Cook" - "easy and effortless."

- COMPOSITION - Letter
Write a letter from Paul to his mother describing his time in England.

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

- Why do you think Paul continued to write dialect poems? And why do they still remain important to read today, over a hundred years later?
 - Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.
- Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 68

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ INTRO

In Book 9, Turnus - king of the Rutulians, ally to King Latinus, and suitor of Lavinia - wages a surprise nighttime attack on the Trojans while Aeneas is away. This book describes the ensuing battle, emphasizing the courage and loyalty of the Trojans, and the human cost of war.

Today's reading picks up in the middle of a battle, and contains many vivid descriptions of violence.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Book 10, lines 471-774 "Suddenly Pallas runs Rhoeteus through" - "scatter all his triumph."

- Compare Pallas and Turnus: what are their similarities and differences as warriors.
- How does this passage illustrate the human cost of war? One place to look is in the epic similes.
- How are the gods involved in the outcome?

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 69

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.91-100 "Now, like I said" - "he'll find you right at home."

- Reflect back on what you read about Paul Laurence Dunbar this term - how would you describe his legacy?
 - Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.
- Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

→ VIEW

Take a brief tour of Paul Dunbar's home in Dayton, and read about the historic site.

∞ Link: Paul Dunbar House Historic Site

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 70

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ INTRO

In Book 11 and the beginning of Book 12, the two armies pause to bury their dead before the fighting continues. Our final reading from The Aeneid picks up at the final duel between Aeneas and Turnus.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Book 12, lines 916-1113 "Now at the same moment" - "down to the shades below."

- What role do the gods play in this final confrontation?
- Why does Aeneas hesitate? What makes him change his mind?
- What do you think of how the epic ends? Why do you think Virgil decided to end the story with the moment of Turnus's death, rather than with peace and the establishment of Rome?

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 71

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
The Aeneid

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 72

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Jump Back, Paul